Upper body hypertrophy — Session A

Focus block · 9 targets · shoulder, elbow, wrist at loading stage 2 · spine at 1 · ~41.5 min · 26 working sets

Muscle group

Chest · Front delt · Side delt · Rear delt · Back · Biceps · Triceps · Abs

Before: upper mobility routine, pre half · then 1–2 light warm-up sets
Outside the exercise time (R19) · use current working loads; new exercises start at the stated RIR

A — Superset 1: Chest + Upper back (~9 min · 3 rounds · 60–90 s after each pair)

1 **Smith machine flat bench press** — 3 × 10–12
Chest (L) · front delt and triceps assist — 3 RIR · wk 5+: 2
Safeties at torso level · wrists over forearms · no bounce — Smith + bench

↕ then immediately

2 **Wide-grip seated cable row** — 3 × 10–12
Upper back (M) · rear delt, lats and biceps assist — 3 RIR · wk 5+: 2
Elbows flared to the shoulder line · reach to ~90–95% — Cable · low pulley

B — Superset 2: Biceps + Front delt (~13 min · 4 rounds · 60–90 s after each pair)

3 **Preacher curl, both arms (DB, bench as the pad)** — 4 × 10–12
Biceps (L) · lower to ~70–80% of the elbow range — 2 RIR · wk 5+: 1
Never hang in the stretch · soft elbow · arms together — DB + bench

↕ then immediately

4 **Dumbbell front raise, both arms** — 4 × 12–15
Front delt (S) · chest assists · thumbs up · stop at shoulder height — 2 RIR · wk 5+: 1
Soft elbow · both arms together · no torso swing — Dumbbells

C — Superset 3: Triceps + Rear delt (~10 min · 3 rounds · 60–90 s after each pair)

5 **Overhead cable triceps extension (bar, facing away)** — 3 × 10–12
Triceps long head (L) · shoulder blades braced (R6) — 2 RIR · wk 5+: 1
Elbows bend to ~70–80% · soft elbow at the top — Cable

↕ then immediately

6 **Band reverse fly (anchored at chest height)** — 3 × 12–15
Rear delt (S) · upper back assists — 2 RIR · wk 5+: 1
Arms stop at the torso plane · soft elbow · arms together — Band + frame

D — Superset 4: Side delt + Abs (~10.5 min · 3 rounds · 60–90 s after each pair)

7 **Dumbbell lateral raise, both arms** — 3 × 12–15
Side delt (S) · raise to 80°, just below shoulder height — 2 RIR · wk 5+: 1
Soft elbow · both arms together · no shrug — Dumbbells

↕ then immediately

8 **Plank (on the forearms)** — 3 × 48–60 s
Abs (M) · spine neutral, no sag into the low back — 8 s in reserve · wk 5+: 4
Too easy at 60 s → harder variant, not longer — Floor

After: mobility post half · day after: no archery
Chest, delts, back, triceps and abs collect sets here — archery's day-before muscles (R21)
Next day, train only if that morning's step gate passes for every joint both sessions load (R20)

Every rep, every set — hypermobility rules

- Lower every rep over 2–3 s; keep a soft bend at every joint, no lockout (R25 · R2)
- Peak effort at ~70–80% of your range, never end range: stage 2 opens full range, not end range (R1 · R3)
- Skip the session if joints feel loose; end a set the moment a joint feels unstable (R9)
- Weeks 1–4: compounds 3 RIR, isolation 2 RIR; from week 5: 2 and 1 (R18) — week 1 = your first session
- Both arms together on every exercise: one-arm work waits for loading stage 3 (R12)
- Holds: end ~8 s before failure (wk 5+: ~4 s); too easy at 60 s → harder variant, not longer (R16)
- Progress: top of the rep range twice → your smallest load step, reps back to the bottom (R42)
- Log the step gate after each session; a fail repeats last week's dose for that joint (§2.6 · R43)

Session timeline

Mobility pre half → warm-up sets → A → B → C → D → mobility post half
Exercise time ≈41.5 min (R40: 4 s a rep, top of every range, 90 s after each pair) · 26 working sets

Working sets — here · week (direct + half-sets from compounds) · ≈10 a target (R33)

Chest 3 · week 10
Front delt 4 · week 7 + 3.5
Side delt 3 · week 10
Rear delt 3 · week 7 + 3
Lats 0 · week 7 + 3
Upper back 3 · week 9 + 2 (1 above, R48)
Biceps 4 · week 7 + 5
Triceps 3 · week 7 + 3.5
Abs 3 · week 10

Alternatives — if a station is taken (each avoids the primary's stations, R41)

#	Primary exercise	Alternative 1	Alternative 2
1	Smith flat bench press	DB floor press	Push-up on DB handles
2	Wide-grip cable row	Band wide row (anchored low)	Bent-over wide DB row
3	Preacher curl	Behind-body cable curl	Band curl, elbows at the sides
5	Overhead cable triceps ext.	Overhead DB ext., two hands ⚠ R6	DB skull crusher